

SENATE No. 518

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Jason M. Lewis, (BY REQUEST)

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act for political party endorsement reform.

PETITION OF:

NAME:

Vincent Dixon

DISTRICT/ADDRESS:

SENATE No. 518

By Mr. Lewis (by request), a petition (accompanied by bill, Senate, No. 518) of Vincent Dixon, for legislation for political party endorsement reform. Election Laws.

[SIMILAR MATTER FILED IN PREVIOUS SESSION
SEE SENATE, NO. 424 OF 2023-2024.]

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act for political party endorsement reform.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 The Massachusetts General Laws are hereby amended by inserting the following new
2 chapter:

3 Chapter 57A. Political Party Endorsement

4 Section 1. An Act to permit certain political party organizational reforms, by allowing a
5 cross-endorsement process, by which more than one political party, may endorse the same
6 candidate, and all votes cast for that candidate, may be totaled for that particular individual.

7 Section 2. Over many years, significant numbers of individuals have desired a greater
8 range of choices for electing public officials, during election periods. This legislation seeks to
9 recognize that an additional choice would be provided, by permitting coalitions of different
10 political designations, and parties, to support, and/or not support, various candidates.

11 Section 3. Present Massachusetts law requires independent, individual candidates by each
12 political party, and/or independent persons. Votes presently, cannot be counted for a single
13 individual, summed in total. In so doing, political choices are limited to certain definitions, that
14 limit the ability of coalitions to form, that would improve voter choices.

15 Section 4. Other states have similar provisions, and have apparently found them to be
16 useful, and appropriate.

17 Section 5. The Massachusetts Secretary of State, and its Elections Division, being the
18 relevant regulator, and supervisor of elections in Massachusetts, is hereby empowered to
19 establish appropriate regulations, by which all recognized political parties, may cross-endorse
20 candidates of other parties, by their particular legal political process.